Damien's Food Pantry

DamiensFoodPantry.org

VOLUNTEER HANDBOOK

January 2024

No one should go to bed hungry.....

Table of Contents

1. Overview of Organization 3
   - Mission Statement 3
   - Board of Directors 3
2. Volunteer Requirements 4
3. Volunteer Opportunities 4
4. Volunteer Rights, Responsibilities and Principles 5
   - Principles of Volunteering 5
   - Equal Volunteering Opportunity 5
   - Gifts, Tips, Soliciting 5
   - Expense Reimbursement 5
   - Parking 5
5. Code of Ethics 6
   - Attendance 6
   - Confidentiality 6
   - Drugs & Alcohol 6
   - Safety 6
6. Volunteer Drivers 6
   - Fuel 7
   - Passengers 7
   - Work Travel 7
   - Off Road Travel 7
   - Vehicle Traffic Incident 7
   - Vehicle Defects 7
   - Damage or Loss of Vehicles 7
7. Volunteer registration form 8
8. Authorization for Background Check 9
9. Volunteer Waiver 10
10. Volunteer Agreement 11
11. Volunteer Release Form for Minors 12
12. Grievance Policy 13
13. Accident Checklist 14
14. Traffic Incident Checklist 15

1. Overview of Organization

We all want to welcome you as a volunteer at The Family Pantry-Damien's Place.

The Family Pantry-Damien's Place (Damien's Food Pantry) has served guests experiencing food insecurity since 1992. Damien's Food Pantry offers a well-balanced selection of food promoting wellness for every individual. Our programs support an average of over 12,000 household visits annually, distributing over one million pounds of food to our community, primarily from Bristol and Plymouth counties, MA. Volunteers are pivotal to the success of Damien's Food Pantry. Each year, volunteers in our organization serve over 8,000 hours to assist those experiencing food insecurity.

This handbook serves as a guide for volunteers working at our pantry. It contains useful information based on best practices that will assist you in your role at Damien's Food Pantry. We hope you will enjoy your time with us. Our goal is to make your experience enjoyable and meaningful while providing the best possible service to our guests. Please note that conditions may warrant changing some of the policies in our Volunteer Handbook. We will endeavor to notify all volunteers of any substantial changes.

Thank you for joining our team!

Mission Statement

Damien's Food Pantry is a not-for-profit organization primarily staffed by volunteers. Our mission is to help end hunger in the greater Wareham/New Bedford area by providing food to people experiencing food insecurity, promoting education and hunger awareness in our community, and providing information to our guests regarding other community resources.

We welcome people of every age, race, ethnicity, national origin, religion, handicap, marital status, sexual orientation, or any status, including the unsheltered, without discrimination.

We collaborate with other organizations that share the mission to address food insecurity in our community.

Board of Directors

The current list of our Board of Directors can be found on our website here: https://damiensfoodpantry.org/directors-staff/.

2. Volunteer Requirements

Damien's Food Pantry relies on volunteers to be the helping hands for our programs that assist approximately 350 households each week. Our volunteers include individuals, families, senior citizens, religious organizations, corporate groups, military members, school groups, scout troops, and many others who help us feed those in need.

Before volunteering, we ask that each prospective volunteer attend a New Volunteer Orientation session led by a staff member or a board member. Additional detailed instructions specific to your chosen pantry duties will be provided when volunteering.

Volunteer opportunities are available in shifts ranging from 2 to 4 hours. It is required that all volunteers wear close-toed shoes. Appropriate comfortable clothes are suggested.

The minimum age to volunteer is 15 years old. All volunteers less than 18 years old, must provide a Waiver document signed by their legal guardian which is included in this Handbook.

We welcome middle school, high school, and college students to volunteer as part of their community service requirement. It is the responsibility of every volunteer to plan and schedule their visit well in advance. All volunteers must register beforehand, either electronically or by reaching out to the Volunteer Coordinator or Team Leader. Contact information and electronic sign-up instructions will be provided to each volunteer. Registration is on a first-come, first-served basis.

Mandatory Volunteer Documents

All volunteers MUST

- Complete the Volunteer Registration Form, (page 8)
- Read and sign the Damien's Food Pantry Volunteer Agreement, (page11)ead
- Complete the Authorization for Background Check (page 9)
- Read and sign the Damien's Food Pantry Volunteer Waiver, (page 10)
- Read and sign the Volunteer Release Form for Minors (if applicable), (Page 12)

Although not a decision to made lightly, to maintain a harmonious environment, the Executive Director can dismiss a volunteer at any time if it becomes necessary.

3. Volunteer Opportunities

Volunteers are the backbone of our Pantry and serve a vital role in the success of our organization and its programs. They help in various positions to ensure that our guests experience an organized and respectful pantry environment. Our current service schedule can be found on our website here: https://damiensfoodpantry.org/visit-pantry/. A detailed list of volunteer opportunities can be found here: https://damiensfoodpantry.org/volunteer/.

There are many ways to serve at Damien's Food Pantry. Thank you for sharing your time, talents, and skills with our organization.

4. Volunteer Rights, Responsibilities and Principles

As a volunteer, you have the right to:

- Work in a clean, healthy, and safe environment
- Receive accurate and truthful information about the organization for which you are volunteering
- Be given a copy of Damien's Food Pantry volunteer policy and any other policy that affects your work
- Be provided with an orientation to our organization
- Have your personal information kept confidential
- Be provided with sufficient training to do your job

Principles of Volunteering

- Volunteering benefits our community and the volunteer
- Volunteer work is unpaid and is not compensated in any manner (except in special circumstances and only if approved by the Executive Director)
- Volunteering is always a matter of choice
- Volunteering is a way in which citizens can participate in the activities of their community
- Volunteering is a vehicle for individuals or groups to address human, environmental, and social needs
- Volunteering respects the rights, dignity, and culture of others

Equal Volunteering Opportunity

Damien's Food Pantry provides equal volunteering opportunities for everyone regardless of sex, color, race, creed national origin, religion, marital status, sexual orientation, political belief, or disability that does not prohibit the performance of essential job functions. All volunteers at least 15 years of age are eligible to volunteer. All matters relating to volunteering are based upon one's ability to perform the job, as well as one's dedication to Damien's Food Pantry mission and needs.

Gifts, Tips, Soliciting

Accepting gifts or tips from guests is not allowed. Promoting or soliciting your own business enterprise, political agenda, or religious beliefs while volunteering at Damien's Food Pantry is not permitted. Any notices posted on Damien's Food Pantry bulletin board must be approved by the Executive Director (ED).

Expense Reimbursement

You must have the ED's authorization prior to incurring an expense on behalf of Damien's Food Pantry. To be reimbursed for all authorized expenses, you must submit the original receipts.

Parking

Damien's Food Pantry does not assume any liability for loss or damage your vehicle may sustain while parked in the parking lot. Volunteers are asked to park in designated areas.

5. Code of Ethics

- There should be proper and authorized use of Damien's Food Pantry equipment, time, and property.
- Removal of Damien's Food Pantry property from the premises without permission is not permitted.
- All safety rules must always be adhered to.
- Volunteers will treat guests, staff, and other volunteers with dignity and respect.
- Threatening, aggressive, or violent behavior or language is not permitted and may lead to dismissal.
- Discriminatory behavior and language, bullying or harassment of any kind is not permitted.
- Behavior or actions that would jeopardize the safety or well-being of other volunteers is not permitted.
- Unauthorized disclosure of confidential information concerning the work of Damien's Food Pantry, its clients or its volunteers is not permitted.
- Smoking on Damien's Food Pantry premises is not permitted within 100 feet of the building.
- Volunteers will dress in a manner suitable for the workplace including closed-toe shoes.

Attendance

We intend to respect your time, and we ask that you respect it by being punctual. If you are running late or need to cancel, please give our office a call as far ahead of time as possible or contact the Team Leader or Volunteer Coordinator. Our phone number is 508.295.3486. If you have registered online, you are asked to cancel your registration for the event.

Confidentiality

We require that you do not disclose any confidential information regarding our guests or any other topic regarding Damien's Food Pantry to any other party without prior permission from the Executive Director.

Drugs & Alcohol

Damien's Food Pantry is a substance-free environment; please respect this policy.

Safety

Any accident, no matter how small, *must* be reported to the Executive Director. Complete the Accident Checklist form found on page 14.

6. Volunteer Drivers

Volunteers are required to observe all traffic regulations. If failure to comply results in fines or other penalties, you must notify the Executive Director. Smoking is not permitted in Damien's Food Pantry vehicle. Pets are not permitted in Damien's Food Pantry vehicle. Excluding an emergency, drivers other than Damien's Food Pantry staff or approved volunteers are not permitted to drive Damien's Food Pantry vehicle. Volunteer drivers are required to undergo a DOT physical once annually. This will be reimbursed to the volunteer, provided documentation of the physical is provided to Damien's Food Pantry. Volunteer drivers are also required to provide a copy of their driver's license which will be submitted to Damien's Food Pantry insurance carrier.

Fuel

The Damien's Food Pantry ISUZU diesel truck uses diesel fuel, and the fuel gauge is expected to show that the tank is over a quarter full. A credit card will be provided to the Volunteer driver to be used to purchase fuel only.

Passengers

Volunteer safety is of paramount importance to Damien's Food Pantry, therefore, providing transport for passengers not associated with the organization's business is prohibited. Volunteers should also refuse to provide transport to persons associated with the organization's business who are intoxicated, under the influence of a prohibited substance, or wanting transport to a location not identified in the volunteer's work-related itinerary. A volunteer has the right to refuse transport requests outside those stipulated above should they have concerns regarding personal safety.

Work Travel

Volunteers must ensure the vehicle and safety equipment are working well prior to starting road travel, required as part of their work duties. Volunteers must ensure the tires, including the spare tire and tire-changing equipment, are serviceable and that oil, water and fuel levels are sufficient prior to traveling. A safety checklist is provided in the glove box of the vehicle.

Off Road Travel

In the interests of personal safety, volunteers are not permitted to take Damien's Food Pantry vehicle on gravel or dirt roads without the prior approval of the Executive Director.

Vehicle Traffic Incident

A copy of the **Traffic Incident Checklist** (page 15) can be found in the vehicle's glove box compartment. In case of a traffic incident, please complete the form and give it to the Executive Director.

Vehicle Defects

Any vehicle with operational faults must be reported to the Executive Director to enable defects to be repaired.

Damage or Loss of Vehicles

In an accident or loss of a vehicle, the driver will comply with all legal and insurance requirements. The driver should immediately obtain particulars of the other parties involved; notify law enforcement of the accident; and inform the Executive Director. The Executive Director will ensure that appropriate action is taken to enable the insurance claim to be processed or the vehicle to be repaired.

7. Volunteer Registration Form

Please note: We are not able to accept court-ordered applicants at this time.
This application is not valid without a signed authorization for Background Check

Name:	
Address:	
E-Mail address:	
Cell Phone:	Home Phone:

I am interested in volunteering for the following types of activities:

☐	Guest Intake – guest check-in, traffic control
☐	Unloading food order and place on shelves
☐	Driver DOT certified, pick-up donations from local stores
☐	Greet guests and assist guests with food selection
☐	Carriage delivery to guests in parking lot
☐	Home deliveries; deliver food to homebound
☐	Sorting/Inspecting food donations
☐	Gardening (Damien's Food Pantry Community Garden)
☐	Data Entry; assorted projects
☐	Interpreter –Which Language?

Available to volunteer: ☐ Weekly ☐ Monthly ☐ Seasonal
How many days per month are you available to volunteer? _____
Days you are available to volunteer:
☐ Week day ☐ Week-end (Saturday). If Week-Day, specify which day(s): _____

Do you have any disabilities that would prevent you from bending, lifting, or carrying anything over 20 lbs.? ☐ Yes ☐ No Explain:_____

How did you hear about Damien's Food Pantry? _____

By signing below, you are giving us permission to use your name/picture in any on-line and/or printed media. You are also opting-in to receiving periodic e-mails, texts, etc. from our organization.

Signature: _____

8. Authorization for Background Check

I, (insert name)_____, hereby authorize the Family Pantry Damien's Place Corp to investigate my background and qualifications for purposes of evaluating whether I am qualified for the volunteer position for which I am applying. I understand that Damien's Food Pantry will utilize an outside firm to assist in checking such information, and I specifically authorize such an investigation by information services and outside entities of Damien's Food Pantry choice. I also understand that I may withhold my permission and that in such a case, no investigation will be done, and my application for a volunteer position will not be processed further.

Additional documentation to be signed will be provided to me for the background check dependent on the method to be utilized by the Family Pantry-Damie's Place.

Signed:_____

Date: _____

Printed Name:_____

9. Volunteer Waiver

1. As a volunteer at Damien's Food Pantry, I hereby agree to hold harmless and waive any and all claims or causes of action against Damien's Food Pantry arising out of any cause whatsoever, including but not limited to claims arising out of negligence or intentional conduct of its volunteers or agents.

2. I attest that I am physically fit and prepared to perform the tasks assigned to me as Damien's Food Pantry volunteer. (Let us know if you have a disability and we will try to find an appropriate task for you.)

3. I further agree to use my personal insurance as the primary provider in the event of injury due to my work as a volunteer for Damien's Food Pantry.

4. I shall not operate a personal vehicle for volunteer activities unless I have a valid Driver's License and at least the minimum amount of liability insurance required by Massachusetts law.

5. Damien's Food Pantry is not responsible for loss or damage to the volunteer's individual property.

6. I also grant Damien's Food Pantry full permission to use photographs of me for publicity and promotional purposes.

I have read, understand, and agree to the above Damien's Food Pantry policy and waiver.

_____ _____ _____

Signature Print name Date

_____

If under 18, a signature of a parent or legal guardian is required Date

_____ _____

Print Name Relationship

10. Volunteer Agreement

Name of Volunteer: _____
Print Name

I have read and agree to uphold the following:

1. Volunteer Rights, Responsibilities & Principles, (page 5)
2. Code of Ethics (page 6)
3. Authorization for Background check (page 9)

Misconduct will include breaches of any of Damien's Food Pantry policies which warrant disciplinary action up to and including Termination. Examples of misconduct include:

- Theft of property, donated food, or funds from Damien's Food Pantry
- Willful damage to Damien's Food Pantry property
- Intoxication through alcohol or other prohibited substance
- Verbal or physical harassment of clients, volunteers, board members, staff members, donors, or any other person
- Disclosure of confidential information regarding Damien's Food Pantry or its guests to any other party without prior permission from the Executive Director
- Falsification of any of Damien's Food Pantry records for personal gain or on behalf of any other volunteer, staff member, or client
- Slander against Damien's Food Pantry

In Return, Damien's Food Pantry will:

- Embrace Damien's Food Pantry Mission and Vision
- Ensure that you have the training and necessary tools to do your work
- Honor and recognize your volunteer service and commitment.
- Always encourage open and honest feedback
- Provide reimbursements for all authorized Volunteer expenses
- Ensure a safe, clean, and volunteer-friendly environment

I have read, understand, and agree with Damien's Food Pantry policy. As a volunteer, I do not expect to be compensated.

_____

Volunteer Signature *Date*

Note: If the volunteer is a minor, a 'Volunteer Release Form for Minors' must be completed by a Parent/Legal Guardian.

11. Volunteer Release Form for Minors

VOLUNTEER RELEASE FORM FOR MINORS (under the age of 18) PARENTAL CONSENT REQUIRED

I, _____, being the parent or legal guardian of _____(the "Minor") hereby consent to and authorize the Minor to act as a volunteer for Damien's Food Pantry. I acknowledge and agree that activities performed by the Minor as a volunteer will be performed strictly on a voluntary basis, without any pay, compensation, or benefits. I agree and understand that the Minor must comply with the rules and regulations established from time to time by Damien's Food Pantry and that failure to do so may result in the Minor's immediate removal as a volunteer.

I am aware of the nature of the activities to be performed by the Minor as a volunteer and recognize that in performing volunteer tasks, a risk of harm or injury exists. I agree that all volunteer activities are to be performed by the Minor at the Minor's risk and I assume full responsibility, therefore.

On behalf of myself, the Minor, and our respective heirs and personal representatives, I agree not to hold or attempt to hold Damien's Food Pantry their population served, volunteers, or staff responsible for any injury or damage sustained or incurred by the Minor, arising out of or in any way connected with the Minor's activities as a volunteer for Damien's Food Pantry. I hereby release and discharge Damien's Food Pantry, their employees, and their volunteers from any and all claims, demands, causes of action of any nature or cause, for any such injury or damage incurred or suffered by the Minor.

_____ _____

Signature of Parent/Legal Guardian Date

_____

Printed Name of Parent/Legal Guardian

_____

Phone Number(s) for Emergencies

_____ _____

Signature of Volunteer Coordinator or Designee Date

_____

Printed Name of Volunteer Coordinator or Designee

Please return to: Damien's Food Pantry Volunteer Coordinator or turn the form in personally to: Damien's Food Pantry.

12. Grievance Policy

A grievance is a real or perceived cause for complaint. You may have a grievance about how you have been treated by another volunteer or staff member.

Damien's Food Pantry recognizes that open communication and feedback are essential elements of a satisfying and productive work environment.

Every effort should be made to solve problems cooperatively and informally before presenting them in writing as a formal grievance. The written submission must be signed, dated, and submitted to the Executive Director. Volunteers are assured they will not be disadvantaged by such procedures whether decisions are made for or against their grievance.

All formal avenues for handling grievances will be fully documented and the Volunteer's wishes considered. All complaints and questions will receive thoughtful consideration in a timely manner and will be discussed with the individual who raises them. Discussions held are kept confidential.

Volunteers at any time have the right to withdraw their grievance.

Grievance Procedure

Step 1

The aggrieved volunteer is encouraged to explore the problem/situation directly with the person(s) involved; clearly outlining what he/she feels should be done to alleviate the situation.

Step 2

If this is not an option for you, discuss the matter directly with the Executive Director.

Step 3

The parties involved will be asked to comply with the best solution identified by all involved. All information will be kept confidential.

13. Accident Checklist

Complete and submit to the Executive Director

Name of Injured_____

Male/Female _____ Age _____

Address _____

Phone (landline) _____ Cell Phone _____

Work Status of injured (Volunteer, Client, Guest, etc.) _____

Incident Date _____ Time _____

Location of Incident_____

Describe How the Incident Occurred _____

_____

_____

_____

Witness Name _____ Phone _____

Address _____

Statement _____

_____

Witness Name _____ Phone _____

Address _____

Statement _____

_____

Was First Aid administered? Yes or No?_____

If Yes, by whom:_____ Phone _____

Was 911 called? Yes or No?_____

If Yes, by whom:_____ Phone _____

Professional Medical Treatment Given? _____

Name of Medical Provider_____

14. Traffic Incident Checklist

Incident Date _____ Time _____

Location of Incident _____

Obtain the other Driver's Name _____

Address _____

Phone Number _____

Insurance Provider _____

Ins Provider Ph Number _____

Other Driver's Car Make, Model and Year _____

License plate # _____

Note any damages to either vehicle _____

_____

Note Injuries _____

ALERT DAMIEN'S FOOD PANTRY EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR AT 508.295.3486

Describe the Incident _____

_____

Witness Name _____ Phone _____

Witness address _____

Witness Statement _____

_____

Was First Aid administered? Yes No Who administered first Aid? _____

Was 911 called? _____ Yes____ No Name _____ Phone _____

Professional Medical Treatment Given? _____

Name of Medical Provider _____

Your contact info: Name _____

Address _____

Phone Landline _____

Phone Mobile _____